

Slovenia



Lying at the junction of central Europe and the Balkans, Slovenia seceded from socialist Yugoslavia in 1991. In 2004, it became the first former Yugoslav state to join the EU.



GEOGRAPHY

Alpine terrain with hills and mountains. Forests cover almost half the country's area. There is a short coastline on the Adriatic Sea.



CLIMATE

Mediterranean climate on the small coastal strip. The alpine interior has continental extremes.



PEOPLE & SOCIETY

Long historical association with western Europe, accounts for the "Alpine" rather than "Balkan" outlook of Slovenia's people, despite close similarities to other former Yugoslavs. The absence of sizable Serb or Croat minorities made for a relatively peaceful secession from Yugoslavia. There are small communities of Italians and Magyars (Hungarians) in the southwest and east respectively.



THE ECONOMY

First new EU member to join eurozone (in 2007). Export-oriented, so vulnerable to global economic trends. Competitive manufacturing industry. Sizable state-owned sector remains.



INSIGHT: A wheel found in a marsh in 2003 is claimed to be the world's oldest, pre-dating 3000 BCE



FACTFILE

OFFICIAL NAME: Republic of Slovenia

DATE OF FORMATION: 1991

CAPITAL: Ljubljana

POPULATION: 2.02 million

TOTAL AREA: 7820 sq. miles

(20,253 sq. km)

DENSITY: 258 people per sq. mile

LANGUAGES: Slovenian*

RELIGIONS: Roman Catholic 96%, other 3%, Muslim 1%

ETHNIC MIX: Slovene 83%, other 12%, Serb 2%, Croat 2%, Bosniak 1%

GOVERNMENT: Parliamentary system

CURRENCY: Euro = 100 cents